ARTICLE 40: Resolution affirming the Town of Marblehead's commitment to the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution

To see if the Town will adopt the following resolution: Resolution affirming the Town of Marblehead's commitment to the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution

WHEREAS, in celebration of the 250th anniversary of our country, the Town of Marblehead recognizes the enduring importance of this nation's founding and the principles articulated in the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution of the United State which have sustained American democracy for nearly two and a half centuries; and

WHEREAS, Constitutional principles of separation of powers, enumerated checks and balances, and the independence of the judiciary, and the protections of free speech, free assembly, and other fundamental rights are steadfast commitments essential to the well-being of our nation and the integrity of its governance; and

WHEREAS, Marblehead proudly exhibits *The Spirit of '76* painting by Archibald Willard in Abbot Hall, which conveys not only the determination to achieve independence from tyrannical power, but also the successful conclusion of the Civil War which secured freedom and union for all; and

WHEREAS, Marblehead has a long and distinguished tradition of resisting authoritarian rule and usurpation of power on land, river, and sea, and of defending liberty through civic engagement, such as through Marblehead's Committee of Grievances established in 1772 by Messrs. Gerry, Orne, Doliber and others; and

WHEREAS the Town of Marblehead is compelled to stand against any threats and harms to these rights and principles.

NOW, THEREFOR, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Town of Marblehead hereby affirms its unwavering commitment to founding principles and documents, civic responsibility, and the rule of law protecting the rights and welfare of all its people as we honor and celebrate the 250th anniversary of the United States of America.

Or take any other action relative thereto. Sponsored by Kate Borten, Lynn Nadeau and others.

Given under our hands at Marblehead aforesaid this
25th day of February 2026.

DAN FOX, Chair

M. C. MOSES GRADER

ERIN M. NOONAN

ALEXA J. SINGER

JAMES R. ZISSON

Select Board of Marblehead

A True Copy
Attest: , Constable

*ADA ADVISORY – Anyone in need of special accommodations for Town Meeting, please contact the office of the Select Board at 781-631-0000 by April 17, 2026, in order that reasonable accommodations may be made.